

Seniors United Now

The Voice of Seniors in Alberta

September 24, 2025

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Subject: Keep Alberta's Seniors Visible, Valued and Supported

Alberta Seniors United Now (SUN) is a non-profit, non-partisan organization established in 2003 to enable all seniors in Alberta to contribute and truly participate in the well-being of the Province of Alberta.

As an organization dedicated to championing the rights and well-being of all Seniors in Alberta, we demand that their voices are heard and insist their needs are prioritized. Issues of health, finances, transportation, and social isolation for Alberta's Seniors require robust government support that cannot be neglected.

Therefore, we are compelled to express our deep concern regarding a series of recent provincial decisions that threaten the health, dignity, and quality of life of Alberta's Seniors.

As an organization, we are concerned that seniors feel invisible and forgotten by the Alberta government. Since May 2025, we have observed a series of decisions that impact older adults, beginning with the removal of the word "Seniors" from the ministry name. This signals a harmful shift in priorities, visibility, and focus away from seniors' issues, which is already evident.

Seniors living independently will soon have to pay for COVID-19 vaccines, which will no longer be available at pharmacies at no cost. This is expected to result in higher hospitalization and death rates among Alberta's seniors. Of the 381 laboratory-confirmed COVID-19 deaths in Alberta from August 25, 2024, to July 5, 2025, 94% were among people aged 60 and older, highlighting their increased vulnerability. This decision to limit vaccine availability sets a dangerous precedent by going against the recommendations of the National Advisory Committee on Immunization. Prescription drug costs for seniors have increased by nearly 7%. This change adds more barriers to seniors living on a fixed income in accessing needed medications.

We respectfully urge the government to immediately reverse these recent decisions, restore access to vaccines and medications, and officially commit to ensuring that Alberta's seniors are visible, valued, and supported in all provincial policies and programs.

Sincerely,

Wayne Sorenson

Wayne Sorenson - President, Seniors United Now

